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Submitter Information

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General Comment

I am a PhD-prepared nurse who studies A.I. and its impacts on patients and communities. A.I. is an extremely broad term that encompasses a myriad of different techniques and technologies. I am deeply concerned about the current lack of transparency with regards to proprietary A.I. tech, and especially surveillant forms of A.I. While clinicians have been told we must safeguard patients from harm and explain how technologies like A.I. function to impact care, this is basically impossible given the way in which both everything from machine learning applications to robots are labeled "A.I." while simultaneously lacking any standardized labeling requirements like model cards (which are not necessarily adequate, but a start) or Federal protections against data-based discrimination. Furthermore, biases baked into extant health databases such as electronic health records continue to be amplified by some forms of this tech, as was the case with Optum's algorithm - one of the first to be formally audited by a team of scientists (Obermeyer and colleagues). The demands of some forms of A.I. such as generative A.I. on planetary resources & unwaged or underwaged labor (in the absence of more thorough audits, regulatory requirements, or policies better safeguarding worker autonomy & occupational safety) poses a significant threat to public health, the climate, & the overall well-being of the U.S. workforce. I urge the NSF & U.S. government to adopt principles of consentful tech and to return to and build upon commitments laid out in the OSTP's previous blueprint for an A.I. bill of rights. Furthermore, as multi-agent forms of generative A.I. pose unique challenges with regards to evaluation, legal status, and collaboration across multiple A.I. systems, I urge extreme caution with regards to any further development, testing or deployment of such tech - whether for research, clinical care delivery, or other purposes.